

Q What clothes will my baby need?

It's best to keep clothing simple for young babies. Your baby will be spending much of his first weeks feeding and napping indoors so you only need to buy a limited supply of items to keep him comfortable.

Newborn babies cannot regulate their body temperature. As they get older, this improves. As a result, it is best to dress them in a onesie, adding more layers as and when required. To start with, buy no more than six cotton onesies with envelope-style necks and snaps around the diaper area, six to eight all-in-one sleep suits with snaps down the front—which are ideal for the first few months, a couple of light

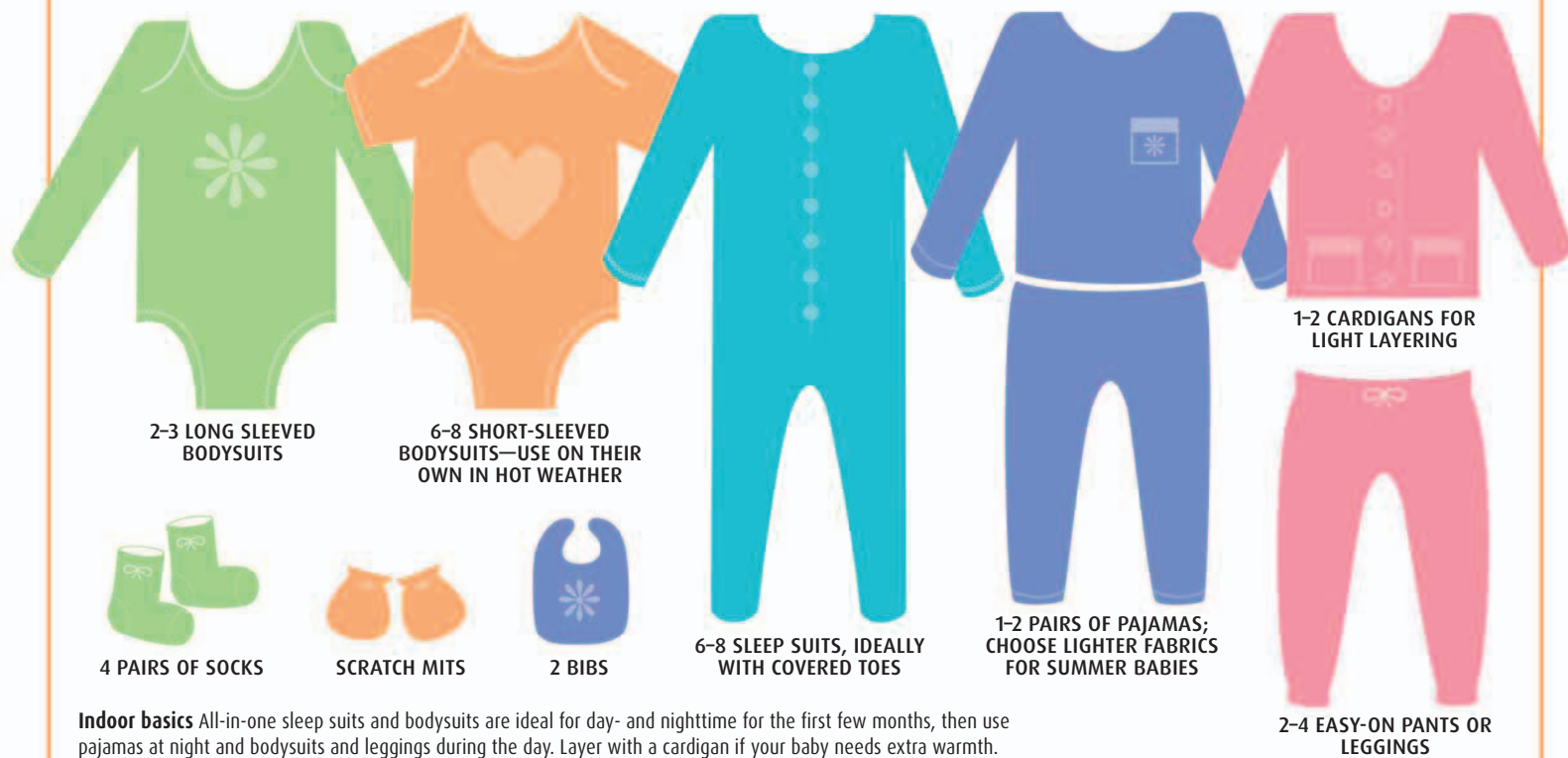
cardigans, a soft hat or wide-brimmed summer hat, a jacket or snowsuit, depending on the season, and some socks to keep his feet warm if they are uncovered. Front-closing outfits rather than items with ties and awkward zippers will be more comfortable for your baby, and make diaper changing much easier. In winter, add onesies under sleep suits, and a lightweight cardigan is useful when the temperature drops.



Layers Try dressing your baby in layers in the beginning so that you can remove or add items easily to regulate his body temperature.

YOUR BABY'S FIRST WARDROBE

Choose baby clothes in soft, easy-care, machine-washable fabrics. Cotton is perfect for babies, since its natural fiber is gentle on your baby's sensitive skin, helps to keep him cool, is easy to wash, and is durable.



Indoor basics All-in-one sleep suits and bodysuits are ideal for day- and nighttime for the first few months, then use pajamas at night and bodysuits and leggings during the day. Layer with a cardigan if your baby needs extra warmth.

Outdoor essentials On hot summer days, a short-sleeved T-shirt or undershirt may be all your baby needs, although do use a sun hat or bonnet and sunscreen too. Otherwise layer onesies with T-shirts, leggings, socks, and cardigans depending on the weather, and invest in a snowsuit or warm jacket, mittens, and a soft hat for winter.

